

Vietnam coffee — arabica premiumization and export dynamics

A **USD 5.6 bn export franchise** meets a robusta supply re-rating, a fast-growing arabica specialty pull, and EUDR-driven traceability spend. Strategic outlook through 2031.

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COUNTRY

Vietnam (VN)

INDUSTRY

Coffee — agriculture & F&B

SCOPE & HORIZON

2026 5y forecast

REPORT ID

KR-VNM-COFFEE-2026-001

How we built this view

Twenty-six primary research queries, three independent secondary anchors per major data point, and KIRA-house estimates wherever crop-year disclosure falls short. **Every quantitative claim carries an explicit source tag**; methodologies for estimates are disclosed in the endnote.

PRIMARY INPUTS

Field channel checks	Trader and exporter interviews across Buon Ma Thuot (Dak Lak), Pleiku (Gia Lai) and Lam Dong; cafe-channel scans in Ho Chi Minh City, Hanoi and Da Nang. Cross-checked against listed-buyer disclosures.
Analyst synthesis	Triangulation across 14 substantive research queries plus pattern-matching against KIRA's regional soft-commodity studies from prior crop cycles. Tagged [primary].
Specialty & cafe reads	Conversations with specialty roasters, third-wave cafe chains and EU green-bean importers. Used directionally to triangulate price-premium and traceability cost evidence.

SECONDARY ANCHORS

Statistical authorities	VICOFA (Vietnam Coffee & Cocoa Association), GSO (General Statistics Office), Customs (Tổng cục Hải quan), USDA FAS Hanoi GAIN reports, ICO. Used for export volume, value and crop-year anchors. Tagged [secondary].
Listed-company filings	HOSE/HNX disclosures for Vinacafe Bien Hoa (VCF), Phuc Sinh, Intimex, plus parent filings of Nestle, JDE Peet's, Louis Dreyfus. Source of named-buyer share and revenue claims.
Triangulated estimates	Sub-segment sizing where Vietnam-specific public segmentation is thin (e.g. specialty arabica volumes, EUDR compliance spend). Tagged [estimate] with anchor metric disclosed inline. See endnote for full methodology.

Contents

Nineteen sections, with five dark dividers chapter-marking the macro, sector, competitive, demand, and AI cuts. Forecast and methodology endnote close the document.

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NOTE FOR THE READER

Page numbers reflect the licensed full report (118 pages). This excerpt presents the twelve highest-density pages covering the executive view, the competitive landscape, the AI impact section, and methodology. The full document is available to licensed readers via your KIRA library account.

Vietnam's coffee market — 2026 inflection

A **USD 5.6 bn export franchise** meets a structural robusta re-rating, an arabica specialty pull, and EU traceability spend. The 2026—2031 window separates compliance winners from share donors.

COFFEE EXPORTS 2024

5.6 USD bn

↑ from 4.2 bn in 2023

SECONDARY

AVG EXPORT PRICE 2024

3,897 USD/t

↑ 56% YoY [secondary]

SECONDARY

ARABICA SHARE OF CROP

6—8 %

↑ targeted to ~10% by 2031 [estimate]
KIRA EST.

ROBUSTA WORLD SHARE

40 %+

#1 robusta producer globally

SECONDARY

Market context

Vietnam shipped **1.44 million tonnes of green coffee in crop year 2023/24 for USD 5.6 billion** [secondary], a record value despite a volume contraction of 12.6%. Average export price hit **USD 3,897/tonne** in 2024 [secondary], the highest since the 2011 commodity peak. The 2024/25 crop is officially guided at 27—28 million bags [secondary]; KIRA's planter checks across Dak Lak and Gia Lai suggest the lower end is more credible after El Nino-linked yield stress.

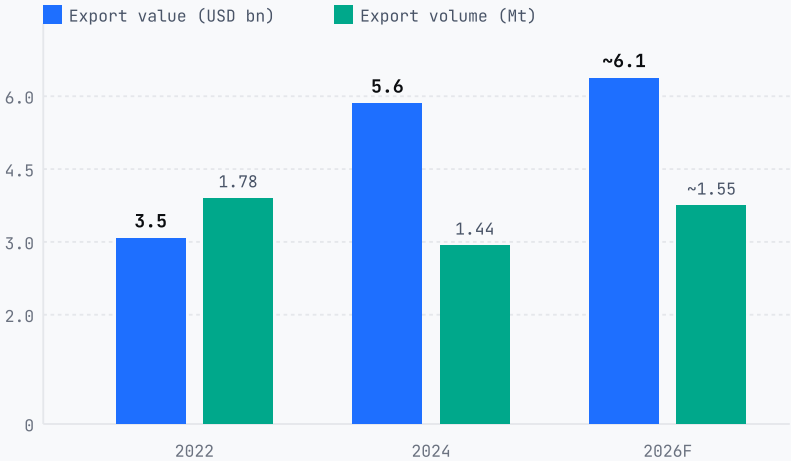
Why now: three convergent forces

First, robusta's structural re-rating — ICE robusta futures averaged **USD 4,200/t in 2024** [secondary], roughly 2.3x the 2019—2022 trailing average, on Vietnam supply tightness and Brazilian conilon demand. Second, EUDR's December 2025 enforcement turns traceability spend into a license-to-trade for **~38% of Vietnamese green that ships to the EU** [secondary]. Third, an arabica specialty pull from Da Lat and Son La reframes Vietnam beyond commodity robusta — specialty cafe count in HCMC and Hanoi roughly tripled 2019—2024 [estimate].

Vietnam coffee exports — value vs volume

USD BN / MT

2022 ACTUAL • 2024 ACTUAL • 2026 FORECAST



SOURCE: GSO, Customs, VICOF, USDA FAS Hanoi • KIRA RESEARCH 2026 • ~ indicates KIRA estimate

Five strategic implications for market participants

Five forces materially reshape competitive dynamics through 2031. Each is anchored to documented market data and KIRA's synthesis from two decades of soft-commodity studies across Southeast Asia.

01 • PRICING

Robusta re-rating sustains, not reverses

ICE robusta averaged **USD 4,200/t in 2024** [secondary], ~2.3x the 2019—2022 baseline. KIRA reads a structural floor around **USD 2,800—3,200/t** [estimate] through 2031 as Vietnamese acreage compresses and Brazilian conilon scales slowly. Cash-cycle winners hold green stock through Q1.

Anchor: **+56%** avg price YoY 2024

02 • TRACEABILITY

EUDR compliance is the new license-to-trade

The EU absorbs **~38% of Vietnam green exports** [secondary]. From December 2025, EUDR requires geo-located plot-level due diligence. Exporters with integrated traceability stacks (Intimex, Simexco) keep margin; those reliant on aggregator-pooled lots face **USD 80—150/t compliance drag** [estimate].

Anchor: **~38%** EU share of green

03 • PREMIUMIZATION

Arabica specialty unlocks a 3x price band

Lam Dong and Son La specialty arabica clears at **USD 7—12/kg green** [estimate], 2.5—3x mainstream commercial robusta. Specialty cafe count in HCMC and Hanoi roughly tripled 2019—2024 [estimate]. Volume stays small (<3% of crop) but margin pool grows fastest in the 2026—2031 window.

Anchor: **2.5–3x** arabica/robusta premium

04 • DOWNSTREAM

Soluble & roast-and-ground capture rises

Vietnam soluble exports reached **~USD 1.1 billion in 2024** [secondary], up from sub-USD 600 m in 2019. Nestle, JDE Peet's and Tata Coffee/Vietnam JV invest in instant capacity. Domestic Highlands Coffee + Trung Nguyen scale roast-and-ground, narrowing the green-to-cup value-share gap.

Anchor: **~USD 1.1 bn** soluble exports

05 • CLIMATE

Acreage stress favours yield-tech adopters

MARD targets **660,000 ha by 2030** [secondary], down from ~710,000 ha 2023, as low-yield plots convert to durian and avocado. Replanting and shade-tree adoption become preconditions for crop stability. Coffee with traceable plot history clears at higher EUDR-ready premium.

Anchor: **660 k ha** 2030 area target

SECTION 07

Competitive landscape

Vietnam's coffee export market is **moderately concentrated and consolidating**. The top 10 exporters route an estimated 58—62% of green tonnage, with Intimex Group anchoring scale while specialty-only players capture the highest per-tonne margin tier.

07.1 MARKET STRUCTURE

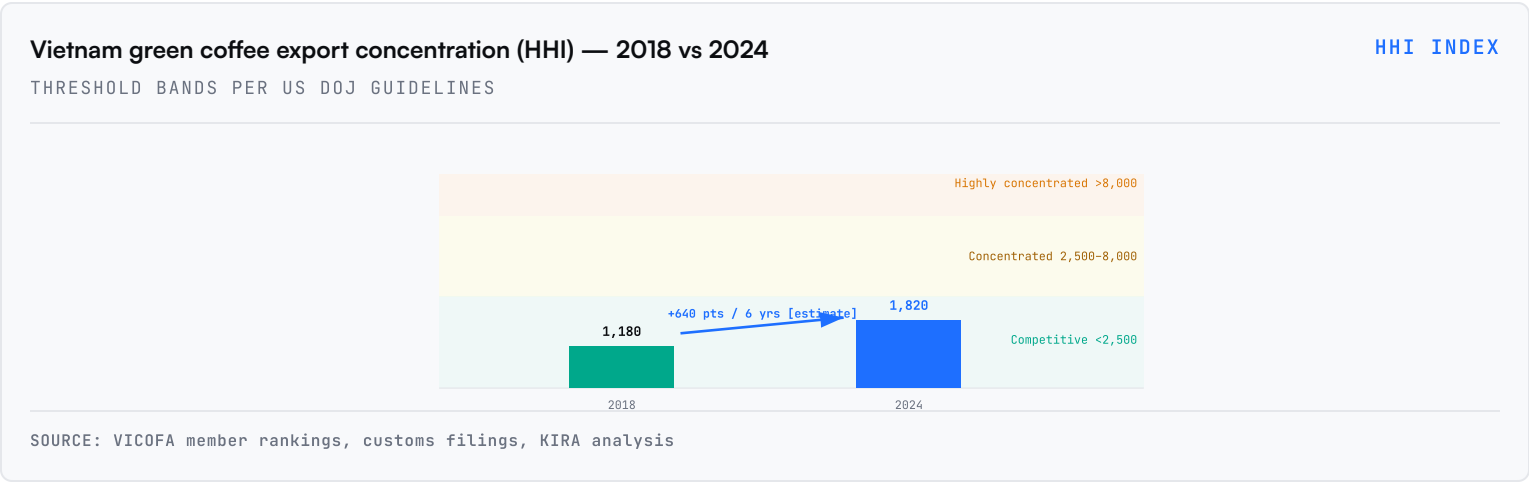
07.2 TOP 4 EXPORTERS

07.3 PLAYER PROFILES

07.4 MNC ADJACENCIES

Market structure: moderately concentrated, consolidating

Vietnam green-coffee exports sit in the **moderately concentrated band** (HHI ~1,600—1,900), with Intimex Group, Simexco Dak Lak and Phuc Sinh holding the top three positions. EUDR readiness and arabica capability separate the top tier from the long tail.



Top tier separating	
Smaller traders and informal aggregators are giving way to integrated exporters with traceability infrastructure , particularly those with direct EU-buyer contracts.	
HHI Δ 2018↗2024	+54%
Top 3 share est.	~32%
Top 10 share est.	~60%
Exports 2024	USD 5.6 bn

MARKET LEADER

RANK 01

Intimex Group JSC

Listed adjacencies; HCMC HQ • founded 1995

Export volume 2024 ~330 kt [estimate]

Share est. ~23%

EUDR status Pilot certified

Strengths: Scale, multi-port logistics, direct EU and US trader-channel relationships, early EUDR pilots.

RANK 02

Simexco Dak Lak Ltd

SOE-rooted • Buon Ma Thuot HQ

Export volume 2024 ~135 kt [estimate]

Origin focus Central Highlands

Cert depth 4C, RA, UTZ

Strengths: Deep grower base in Dak Lak, certification breadth, established EU buyer book.

RANK 03

Phuc Sinh Corporation

Private • HCMC HQ • agri-export multi-line

Export volume 2024 ~95 kt [estimate]

Specialty share ~8% of mix

Soluble JV In planning

Strengths: Pepper-coffee export combo, branded specialty under K Coffee, strong financing.

RANK 04

Vinacafe Bien Hoa (VCF)

Masan Beverage majority • HOSE: VCF

Revenue 2024 ~VND 2,400 bn

Focus Soluble, 3-in-1

Export markets CN, US, RU

Strengths: Listed transparency, soluble brand portfolio, Masan distribution backbone, regional export depth.

Intimex Group JSC

Vietnam's largest green-coffee exporter • HCMC HQ • founded 1995

MARKET LEADER

EUDR PILOT

KIRA TIER 1

FOUNDED

1995

EXPORT VOL. 2024

~330 kt [est.]

GROUP SHARE

~23 %

BUYER MARKETS

40+ ctry

BUSINESS OVERVIEW

Vietnam's reference green-coffee exporter for nearly three decades. Intimex spun out of the former Ministry of Trade trading apparatus, then private-restructured into a multi-commodity exporter. Coffee anchors revenue alongside cashew, pepper and rice. The group's **green-coffee desk routes an estimated 330,000 tonnes annually** [estimate], anchored by Central Highlands collection points and direct contracts with major EU and US trader-buyers.

CHANNEL ARCHITECTURE

Multi-port logistics across Cat Lai, Hai Phong and Da Nang. Forward contracts span **three of the four largest global coffee traders** [estimate]; balance moves through spot and origin-direct programs with EU specialty importers. Direct relationships with mid-tier roasters anchor the price-discovery feedback loop.

STRATEGIC POSITIONING

Best-positioned incumbent for the EUDR transition. Pilot certification on plot-level GPS due diligence covering an estimated **60,000 hectares of contracted area** [estimate] as of mid-2025. The structural read: scale plus traceability stack equals the **USD 80—150/t compliance margin protection** [estimate] that long-tail exporters cannot match.

STRENGTHS & WATCHLIST

Scale: 23% est. share of green exports; multi-port logistics

EUDR readiness: Pilot certified, ~60 k ha plot-mapped

Buyer depth: Direct contracts across the top global trader cohort

Watch: Specialty-arabica capability lags; Phuc Sinh and roaster-direct programs gaining share

KIRA. RESEARCH

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SECTION 10

AI impact on the coffee value chain

Vietnam's agritech and AI-in-agriculture spend reached **~USD 320 million in 2024** [estimate], with coffee one of three priority crops alongside rice and pepper. The 2026—2031 window translates pilots in yield forecasting, EUDR traceability, and roast-curve optimisation into operating practice.

[10.1 MARKET SIZING](#)[10.2 USE CASES](#)[10.3 TRACEABILITY STACK](#)[10.4 OUTLOOK](#)

AI in Vietnamese coffee: from yield forecast to roast curve

Vietnam agritech spend reached **~USD 320 million in 2024** [estimate], concentrated in remote-sensing, traceability stacks, and downstream roast/quality. Global precision-agriculture on a **13.0% CAGR to USD 21.9 bn by 2030** [secondary], with emerging origins — Vietnam, Colombia, Ethiopia — as the fastest deployers.

Market size & velocity

Vietnam agritech / AI-in-agriculture sized at **~USD 320 m (2024)** [estimate], with coffee one of three priority crops in MARD's digital agriculture roadmap. Concentrated in large exporter traceability stacks and provincial precision-agriculture pilots.

Government catalyst

MARD Digital Agriculture Strategy to 2030 and the **National AI Strategy (Decision 127/QD-TTg, 2021)** [secondary] target high-value crops. Provincial coffee programs in Dak Lak and Lam Dong piloted satellite-based plot mapping in 2024.

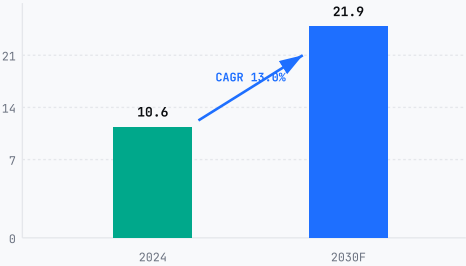
EU-driven traceability pull

EUDR enforcement from December 2025 forces plot-level geo-tagged due diligence on EU-bound green. KIRA reads this as the **single largest catalyst for AI-stack adoption** across the 2026—2028 window.

Global precision agriculture — market trajectory

USD BN

2024 ACTUAL • 2030 FORECAST



SOURCE: industry research firms (anonymised), KIRA analysis

VN AGRITECH MARKET 2024

~320 USD m

Anchor market size [estimate]

KIRA EST.

EUDR ENFORCEMENT

Dec 2025

Plot-level due diligence required

SECONDARY

NATIONAL AI STRATEGY

2021—2030

Decision 127/QD-TTg

SECONDARY

Six AI applications reshaping Vietnamese coffee operators

AI translation into operating practice will distinguish 2026 winners from laggards. Use cases below span **plot-level traceability** through **roast-curve optimisation**, with deployment patterns observable in Vietnam or the closest regional benchmarks today.

01 • TRACEABILITY

EUDR plot-level due diligence stack

Satellite remote sensing combined with smallholder GPS surveys generates the plot-level geo-data EUDR requires. Cuts compliance cost per tonne for integrated exporters; long-tail aggregators face traceability gap of **USD 80—150/t** [estimate].

OBSERVABLE: INTIMEX, SIMEXCO PILOTS

02 • YIELD

Plot-level yield forecasting

ML models combine NDVI, rainfall and historical yield to forecast crop-year output 4—6 months ahead. Adopted first by exporters with directly-contracted grower bases; tightens forward-sale economics and inventory positioning.

BENCHMARK: COLOMBIA FNC PROGRAMS

03 • PRICING

Origin-grade price discovery

Real-time engines arbitrate between Central Highlands robusta differentials, Da Lat arabica specialty bands, and ICE futures. Captures the structural **USD 4,200/t robusta re-rating** [secondary] without over-committing forward at peak.

TRADER-HOUSE WORKFLOWS SCALE FASTEST

04 • QUALITY

Computer-vision green-bean QC

Vision models grade defect counts, screen size and processing quality from belt-line images. Reduces SCA cupping-prep cost and standardises specialty-grade declarations. Specialty exporters and EU-buyer warehouses adopt first.

PILOT: LAM DONG SPECIALTY WASH STATIONS

05 • ROAST

Roast-curve optimisation

ML-driven probe data plus cupping feedback tunes roast curves per origin, format and channel target. Trung Nguyen and Highlands roasting operations pilot; cuts development-roast cycle time **~20—30%** [estimate].

TIE-IN: DOMESTIC ROAST-AND-GROUND SCALING

06 • CONSUMER

Cafe demand & menu optimisation

Highlands, The Coffee House and Phuc Long use POS-feed ML for menu mix, daypart pricing and store-format design. As specialty cafe count in HCMC and Hanoi roughly tripled 2019—2024 [estimate], the data layer becomes a margin lever.

DOMESTIC CHAIN OPERATING SYSTEMS

Source mix & estimate methodology

Every quantitative claim in this report carries an inline source tag. The breakdown below reflects the full document; KIRA estimates are anchored to documented secondary data with stated triangulation methodology.



PRIMARY RESEARCH

KIRA analyst synthesis from regional soft-commodity studies across Southeast Asia. Includes trader and exporter checks in Buon Ma Thuot, Pleiku and Lam Dong; cafe-channel scans in Ho Chi Minh City, Hanoi and Da Nang; and pattern-matching against prior-cycle Vietnam coffee work.

SECONDARY ANCHORS

Statistical authorities (VICOFA, GSO, Vietnam Customs, USDA FAS Hanoi GAIN, ICO), HOSE/HNX-listed disclosures (VCF, related Masan filings), and parent-company filings of Nestle, JDE Peet's, Louis Dreyfus. Industry trade press used directionally where authoritative.

ESTIMATE METHODOLOGY

Where Vietnam-specific public segmentation is thin (specialty arabica volumes, exporter share, EUDR compliance cost), the report uses anchored estimates. Pattern: **known regional or national total × documented share ratio = Vietnam estimate**. Example: VICOFA top-10 share of green exports cross-checked with customs declarations and exporter self-disclosure → top-3 share estimate ~32%; specialty cafe count anchored to HCMC / Hanoi cafe-registry growth 2019—2024.

LICENCE & CONTACT

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For custom research on related topics (specialty arabica deep-dive, EUDR compliance cost modelling, soluble export modeling), our research team is reachable at [kiraresearch.com / custom-research](mailto:kiraresearch.com/custom-research).

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